Select the correct answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (c): Green India Mission was launched in 2014. It is one of the eight missions under the National Action Plan on Climate change (NAPCC). Its objective is to respond to climate change by a combination of adaptation and mitigation measures. It is aimed at protecting, restoring and enhancing India's diminishing forest cover. Hence, (3) is correct.

It is one of the main objectives to enhance annual CO_2 sequestration by 50-60 million tons by 2020. Hence, (1) and (2) are irrelevant to the mission.

73. With reference to an initiative called The Economics of Ecosystems and Biodiversity (TEEB), Which of the following statements is/ are correct?/

1. It is an initiative hosted by UNEP,IMF and World Economic Forum.
2. It is a global initiative that focuses on drawing attention to the economic benefits of biodiversity.
3. It presents an approach that can help decision-makers recognize, demonstrate and capture the value of ecosystems and biodiversity.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 3 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (c) : The Economics of Ecosystems and Biodiversity (TEEB) is a global initiative whose objective is to mainstream the values of biodiversity and ecosystem services into the decision- making at all levels. It aims to achieve this good by following a structured approach to valuation that helps decision-makers recognize the wide range of benefits provided by ecosystems and biodiversity, demonstrate. Their values in economic terms and, appropriate, capture those values in decision-making. Therefore, statement (2) and (3) are correct. It was started by G8+5 Environment Ministers in 2007.

74. Which of following statements is/are correct ? Proper design and effective implementation of UN-REDD+ Programme can significantly contribute to

1. Protection of biodiversity
2. Resilience of forest ecosystems
3. Poverty reduction

Select the correct answer using the code given below

(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 3 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1,2 and 3

Ans. (d): Reducing emissions from deforestation and forest degradation (REDD) is a mechanism that has been under negotiation by the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC) since 2005, with the objective of mitigating climate change through reducing net emissions of greenhouse gases through enhanced forest management in developing countries.

• Under REDD + Developing countries will have to prove the 'result' that they have fought deforestation without harming local communities or biological diversity, only then they will get the money.

Therefore, (1) and (2) are correct. Although REDD+ has galvanized significant support internationally among both developed and developing countries, its implications for poverty alleviation at the local level remain unclear. Hence, statement (3) is incorrect. Therefore, the answer is (a).

75. What is 'Greenhouse Gas Protocol' ?

(a) It is an international accounting tool for government and business leaders to understand, quantify and manage greenhouse gas emissions
(b) It is an initiative of the United Nations to offer financial incentives to developing countries to reduce green house gas emissions and to adopt eco-friendly technologies.
(c) It is an inter-governmental agreement ratified by all the member countries of the ratified by all of the United Nations to reduce greenhouse gas emission to specified level by the year 2022.
(d) It is one of the multilateral REDD+initiatives hosted by the World Bank

Ans. (a) : The Greenhouse Gas (GHG) protocol developed by World Resources Institute (WRI) and World Business Council of Sustainable Development (WBCSD), sets the global standard for how to measure, manage, and report greenhouse gas emissions. Many companies and organization around the world are using GHG protocol standards and tools to manage their emissions and become more efficient, resilient and prosperous organizations.

76. Which reference to 'Agenda 21' sometimes seen in the news, consider the following statements :

1. It is a global action plan for sustainable development.
2. It originated in the World Summit on Sustainable Development held in Johannesburg in 2002.

Which of the statements given above is /are correct?

(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (a): Agenda 21 is a non-binding action plan of the United Nations with regard to sustainable development. It is the product of the Earth Summit (UN Conference on Environment and Development) held in Rio de Janeiro, Brazil, in 1992.

The implementation of the Agenda is primarily the responsibility of governments, through national strategies, plans, policies and procedures. International and regional organizations are also called upon to contribute to this effort. The broadest public participation and the active involvement of non-governmental organizations and other groups are encouraged.

77. 'Gadgil Committee Report' and 'Kasturirangan Committee Report' sometimes seen in the news, are related to

(a) Constitutional reforms
(b) Ganga Action Plan
(c) Linking of rivers
(d) Protection of Western Ghats

Ans. (d): The Kasturirangan panel was set up to study the Gadgil committee report on the Western Ghats. The Kasturirangan report seeks to bring just 37% of the Western Ghats under the Ecologically Sensitive Area (ESA) zones-down from the 64% suggested by the Gadgil report.

It recommended prohibition on development and commercial activities like mining, thermal power plants, polluting industries and large housing plans in Ecologically Sensitive Areas (ESA) zones.

CURRENT AFFAIRS

78. The term 'Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership' often appears in the news in the context of the affairs of a group of countries known as

(a) G-20 (b) ASEAN
(c) SCO (d) SAARC

Ans. (b): Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership (RCEP) is a proposed free trade agreement (FTA) between the ten member states of the Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN)+(RCEP) (Brunei, Myanmar, Cambodia, Indonesia, Laos, Malaysia, Philippines, Singapore, Thailand and Vietnam) and the six states with which ASEAN has existing FTAs (Australia, China, Japan, South Korea and New Zealand).

79. 'European Stability Mechanism', sometimes seen in the news, is an

(a) agency created by EU to deal with the impact of millions of refugees arriving from Middle East.
(b) agency of EU that provides financial assistance to eurozone countries.
(c) agency of EU to deal with all the bilateral and multilateral agreements on trade.
(d) agency of EU to deal with the conflicts arising among the member countries.

Ans. (b): The European Stability Mechanism is a European Union Agency that provides financial assistance, in the form of loans, to eurozone countries as new capital to banks in difficulty.

80. Recently, for the first time in our country, which of the following State has declared a particular butterfly as 'State Butterfly'?

(a) Arunachal Pradesh (b) Himachal Pradesh
(c) Karnataka (d) Maharashtra

Ans. (d): Maharashtra has become the first state in the country to have a state as the Butterfly State. The Government has declared the Blue Mormon (*Papilio polymnestor*) as the state butterfly.

81. A recent movie titled The Man Who Knew Infinity is based on the biography of

(a) S. Ramanujan (b) S. Chandrasekhar
(c) S. N. Bose (d) C.V. Raman

Ans. (a): 'The man who knew Infinity' movie is based on a book by the same name written by Robert Kanigel on the life and times of Ramanujan. The film stars Dev Patel as the real -life Srinavasa Ramanujan. Distinguished mathematicians Manjul Bhargava and Ken Ono are Associate producers of the film.

82. With reference to 'LiFi' recently in the news. Which of the following statements is/ are correct?

1. It uses light as the medium for high-speed data transmission.
2. It is a wireless technology and is several time faster than 'WiFi'.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) 1 and 2 only (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (c): Statement 1: Li-Fi is loosely expanded to Light- Fidelity using precisely controlled light modulation data that can be transmitted using regular, visible light.

Statement 2 : It will be 10-100 times faster than current generation, WiFi, and also very secure.